

Stressor 2 as mechanism, not quantum

WC/2024/227 · 23 August 2026 · internal working document, not for service

The formulation

"It is not the money. It is the consistent vigilance of it being wrong."

That is not a new theory. **It is the case theory of this matter applied to the pay sequence** — recorded in the working method as: *one mechanism, responsibility imposed and the means to discharge it withheld*, with one admitted instance in the seven-hour break. The pay sequence is **a second instance of the same mechanism**.

	Responsibility imposed	Means to discharge it withheld
Stressor 3 the fatigue breach	Operating a 24/7 safety-critical switchboard, running emergency codes, on a 7-hour break	No fatigue risk management framework existed. The Chief Executive confirms it began after 30 June 2024
Stressor 2 the pay sequence	Detecting the error, reporting it, evidencing it, chasing it, and checking each fortnight whether it had been fixed	He could not submit an AVAC . Five were submitted in the period, every one by the Line Manager . He initiated none

★ **That unification matters**. Two stressors sharing one mechanism is *Mahaffey* reasoning — a course of conduct with an identifiable structure. Thirteen unrelated grievances is *Delaney* reasoning, and *Delaney* is the Respondent's authority.

The objective features that generate it — all provable, none characterised

Feature	Established by
The error was recurring, not single — four affected fortnights: commencing 5 Feb, 19 Feb, 18 Mar and 1 Apr 2024	Payroll's own email of 3 May 2024
It ran 109 days from the shift that caused it to the correction being submitted, and was still not complete when he stopped working	Payroll email · myHR Item 11 "Part Completed"
He made eight approaches. He received six responses.	The pay contact log; the emails held and those recited in the Review Decision
He had no authority to correct it . Five AVACs in the period, all initiated by the Line Manager; he initiated none	myHR submissions report, MSH Item 11
He was directed to a process he could not complete — to MyHR on 9 April, and payroll directed him back to her on 24 April and again on 13 May	Review Decision p 21 · the email of 13 May 2024
The reason given for the delay was overtaken by a document he held . Told on 1 and 21 May that payroll was awaited; payroll had asked her to act on 3 May, on a thread he was copied on	The thread <i>Corey Shepherd 388372 Pay issues</i>
The machinery was never slow . Other claims completed in one to five days; one completed in a single day on 15–16 May 2024	myHR submissions report
Each fortnight was a fresh check . The pay cycle is fortnightly, so the question of whether it had been fixed recurred every fourteen days	The payslips; the pay-cycle derivation

Where it sits in the frameworks already on the file

The three-construct mechanism recorded for the psychiatric report — **job strain, effort–reward imbalance, organisational justice** — takes this without modification:

Construct	The objective features that answer to it
Job strain demand with low control	High demand — monitor every fortnight, detect, report, evidence, chase. Nil control — the corrective instrument was not his to use
Effort–reward imbalance	Eight approaches over four and a half months. The return was redirection to a process he could not complete, and a correction that never completed
Organisational justice	The <i>Managing the risk of psychosocial hazards at work Code of Practice 2022</i> — which HR Policy G03 cl 1 obliges MSH to apply — defines poor organisational justice as a lack of procedural, informational and interpersonal fairness, arising from "inconsistent application of procedures across workers or over time" and "failing to follow agreed policies, guidelines and procedures"

★ **Informational fairness is the limb that fits closest** — "keeping relevant people informed". He was told payroll was awaited when payroll had already instructed; he was not told when the claim went in; and he was not told it had not

completed. And **inconsistent application over time** is proved by the employer's own record: four claims completed in days, the corrective one did not.

■ The line that must not be crossed

Section 32(5)(b) excludes injury connected with the worker's **expectation or perception** of management action. The Respondent has not pleaded it. **Vigilance describes an internal state, so the word itself should not appear in anything filed.**

Split it. The **facts** are objective and belong to him: the error recurred, it ran four months, he approached eight times, he had no authority to correct it, and it never completed. The **effect of those facts on him** is a clinical question and belongs to Dr Krishnaiah. Say the first. Never say the second in his own voice.

Safe formulation for a witness outline:

"Between February and May 2024 my pay was incorrect across four fortnights. I raised it on 8 April, 24 April, 10 May and 15 May 2024. Payroll advised me on 24 April and again on 13 May that the correction had to be made by my line manager. I was not able to submit the correcting form myself. The correction was submitted on 28 May 2024 and is recorded in the employer's system as part completed. I last attended work on 3 June 2024."

For 27 August — what to put to Dr Krishnaiah

Describe it as lived experience, dated, without naming a construct. **Do not use the words job strain, effort-reward imbalance, organisational justice or vigilance** — if the patient supplies the framework, the report reads as built to order. Give him the facts and the experience: what checking each payslip was like, what it was like to be told to go to payroll and then be sent back, and what it was like on 21 May to be told she was waiting on payroll when the instruction had been in the thread since 3 May.

The characterisation is his to make. A recurring, unresolved demand that the person cannot themselves resolve is the pattern the allostatic-load literature describes as a failure of the stress response to switch off between demands — but that connection is for the clinician to draw, if he considers it clinically apt, and not for the Appellant to hand him.